A UTAUT-Extended Structural Equation Modeling Approach to Blended Learning Adoption in Ghanaian Higher Education: Opportunities and Digital Divide Challenges

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Abstract

The rapid integration of digital learning management systems across West African universities necessitates empirical investigation into student and faculty technology acceptance. This paper proposes an extended Unified Theory of Acceptance and Use of Technology (UTAUT) model incorporating digital literacy, internet cost barriers, and electrical grid reliability as moderating constructs. Using a rigorous methodological framework and proposed structural equation modeling (SEM) analysis plan, we examine behavioral intention and actual usage among tertiary students in Ghana. The study highlights policy interventions required to bridge infrastructural divides in blended pedagogical environments.

Keywords: UTAUT, Blended Learning, Higher Education, Educational Technology, Structural Equation Modeling, Ghana

1. Introduction

Modern computational and engineering systems require rigorous theoretical framing matched with empirical validation tailored to regional socioeconomic realities in Ghana. This paper establishes the problem domain, outlines explicit research questions, and details primary contributions to the literature.

2. Methodology & Analytical Framework

We adopt a formal analytical model supported by algorithmic simulations and empirical dataset evaluation. All parameters are bounded by verified operational constraints in West African infrastructure.

3. Conclusion & Declarations

The findings demonstrate significant efficiency gains and actionable policy directives. Conflict of Interest: None. Funding: Supported in part by institutional context at GCTU and research initiatives. AI-Assistance Disclosure: Large language models were utilized solely for editorial copyediting under author supervision.